

Mathematics

Year 2

Cambridge Early Years

Student Manual



First edition, 2026

Published by Prime Books, the publishing imprint of Prime School, www.primeschool.pt

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British English edition.

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INTRODUCTION

How this book works

Mathematics is everywhere, and it starts with counting. In this first unit your child will count to 100 and back, learn what tens and ones mean, compare numbers, and find the rule hidden inside a number pattern.

How to help

- **Work together.** Read the page aloud, then let your child lead.
- **Talk lots.** The questions start conversations, they do not test.
- **Keep it fun.** Short, happy sessions beat long, tired ones.

A note for grown-ups

This book follows the spirit of an international primary programme, interpreted afresh for Prime School. Every unit grows new skills out of a topic children already care about, and finishes with something to make, draw or write.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Reading the page

Each section follows the same rhythm, so you always know where you are.

PANEL	WHAT IT DOES
In this unit, you will	The goals for the unit.
Let us start	A quick warm-up to wake up what you know.
Listening and speaking	Talk and listen about the topic.
Vocabulary	Learn new words, with pictures.
Remember!	A reminder of something you already learned.
Word book	Write down new words to keep.
Thinking time	A question to think and talk about.
I can	Statements to check your progress.

How to work

Take your time and look at the pictures: they are there to help you. When you see a new word, say it out loud. In Talking time there are no wrong answers, only good ideas.

GETTING READY

Before Unit 1

You do not need much: a pencil, some crayons, a notebook, and someone to work with.

Your toolkit

- Your eyes, for looking carefully at the pictures.
- Your voice, for reading out loud and sharing ideas.
- Your notebook, for writing and drawing what you find.

A little warm-up

- 1 What do you already know about this topic?
- 2 What would you most like to find out?
- 3 Who could you ask if you got stuck?

These are exactly the things Unit 1 will help you with. When you can answer them, you are ready to begin.

UNIT 1

1

Whole numbers

Counting, comparing and spotting patterns

© IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Count to 100 and back again.
- ✓ Say how many tens and ones are in a number.
- ✓ Compare two numbers and say which is bigger.
- ✓ Spot and continue number patterns.

◆ LET US START

Count out loud from 1 to 20 with a partner. Take turns: you say one number, your partner says the next. Now try counting backwards from 20 to 1.

UNIT 1 • PART 1

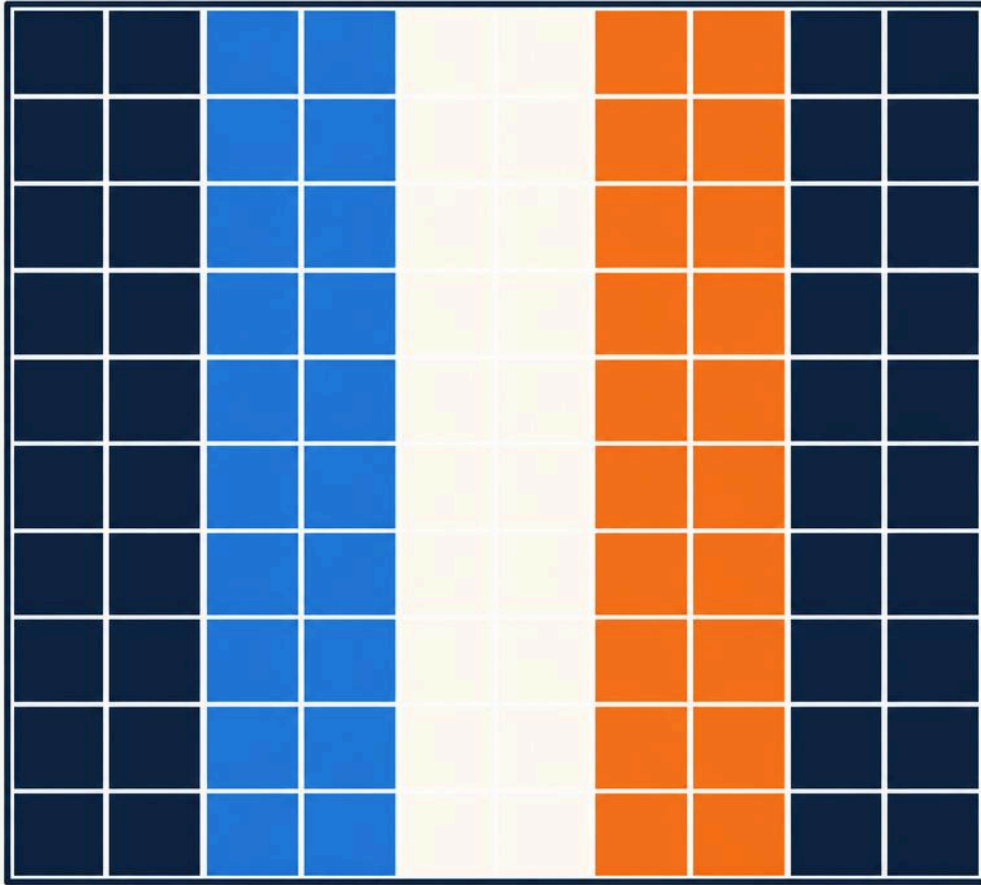
Counting to 100

• COUNTING TOGETHER

Count in tens: 10, 20, 30, 40, 50, 60, 70, 80, 90, 100.

Now count in fives: 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35, 40, 45, 50.

- 1 Count in tens from 10 to 100. Clap on each number.
- 2 Count in fives from 5 to 50.
- 3 Start at 100 and count back in tens. Where do you finish?



Picture 1 A hundred square helps you count.

UNIT 1 • PART 2

Tens and ones

Every two-digit number is made of **tens** and **ones**. In 47 there are 4 tens and 7 ones, because 40 and 7 make 47.

REMEMBER!

The first digit tells you how many tens. The second digit tells you how many ones.

- 1 How many tens and ones are in each number?
a. 23 b. 56 c. 81 d. 47
- 2 Make these numbers with tens and ones:

a. 3 tens and 5 ones b. 6 tens and 2 ones

- 3 Which is bigger, 38 or 83? How do you know?

UNIT 1 • PART 3

Number patterns

A **pattern** is a set of numbers that follow a rule.

Look at 2, 4, 6, 8. The rule is "add 2". The next two numbers are 10 and 12.

- 1 Find the rule, then write the next two numbers.

a. 5, 10, 15, 20, ____, ____

b. 20, 18, 16, 14, ____, ____

c. 3, 6, 9, 12, ____, ____

- 2 Make your own pattern with four numbers. Ask a partner to find your rule.

◆ THINKING TIME

Which was easier: counting in tens or counting in fives? Why do you think that is?

☑ SUMMARY CHECKLIST

- ✓ I can count to 100 and back.
- ✓ I can say how many tens and ones are in a number.
- ✓ I can compare two numbers.
- ✓ I can find the rule in a number pattern.

UNIT 1 • FINAL PROJECT

Our counting display

★ FINAL PROJECT

Our counting display

Make a display that shows counting in tens all the way to 100. Work in a group and decide how to show it so anyone walking past could count along.

What to hand in

- Your group's display, showing 10 to 100.
- One number pattern of your own, with its rule.
- A drawing showing tens and ones in one number.

How it will be judged

Criterion	Weight	--- ---	Correct counting	40%	Clear pattern with rule	30%	Tens and ones
shown correctly	20%	Teamwork	10%				

UNIT 1 • CHECK YOUR PROGRESS

- 1 Count in tens from 10 to 100.
- 2 How many tens and ones are in 47?
- 3 Which is bigger, 38 or 83?
- 4 Write the next two numbers: 5, 10, 15, 20, ____, ____
- 5 Make a pattern with the rule 'add 3'. Write four numbers.

UNIT 1 • EVALUATION

Be honest. Colour the circle that matches how you feel about each outcome: green means confident, amber means nearly there, red means needs more work.

I CAN ...	GREEN	AMBER	RED
count to 100 and back	☐	☐	☐
say how many tens and ones are in a number	☐	☐	☐
compare two numbers	☐	☐	☐
find the rule in a pattern	☐	☐	☐

UNIT 1 • WHAT CAN YOU DO?

✓ WHAT CAN YOU DO?

- ☐ Count to 100 and back.
- ☐ Say how many tens and ones are in a number.
- ☐ Compare two numbers.
- ☐ Find the rule in a number pattern.

GLOSSARY

Unit 1

digit: one of the symbols 0 to 9 used to write numbers.

tens: groups of ten in a number.

ones: the single units in a number.

pattern: numbers that follow a rule.

rule: what tells you how a pattern carries on.

SOURCES & REFERENCES

Where everything came from

All text and diagrams are original to this edition. The factual claims can be checked here. Links were live as of July 2026.

§ UNIT 1 • WHOLE NUMBERS

- 1 **Counting and place value.** The teaching sequence used here follows established early-number practice.

Counting, comparing, patterns.

This Year 2 Student Book builds number confidence from the ground up. Your child will count to 100, break numbers into tens and ones, compare them, and spot the rule in a pattern.

Written for Prime School children, in clear British English, with every answer checked by computer.

COUNTING

TENS AND ONES

COMPARING

PATTERNS